

Candidate Number

Candidate Name _____

INTERNATIONAL ENGLISH LANGUAGE TESTING SYSTEM

Academic Reading

Additional materials:

Answer sheet for Listening and Reading

Time 1 hour

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Do not open this question paper until you are told to do so.

Write your name and candidate number in the spaces at the top of this page. Read the instructions for each part of the paper carefully.

Answer all the questions.

Write your answers on the answer sheet. Use a pencil.

You must complete the answer sheet within the time limit.

At the end of the test, hand in both this question paper and your answer sheet.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

There are **40** questions on this question paper.

Each question carries one mark.

READING PASSAGE 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

Living walls – a successful environmental project

Gardens planted on vertical walls are useful as well as decorative

Canadian entrepreneur Alan Darlington, president of Nedlaw Living Walls and holder of a PhD in plant sciences, admits that people may have a point when they say that academics don't necessarily make good businessmen. While good ideas come up in university labs and classrooms all the time, he acknowledges that bringing them to the marketplace requires a different skill set. Yet Dr Darlington's combination of two existing green technologies into a single breakthrough innovation is not only a laboratory success story, but the heart of what is today a multi-million-dollar business. And, he says, 'I've been a part of the whole sequence, from working in the lab to making it work as a business.'

In fact, Dr Darlington's invention was originally designed with space exploration projects in mind. His work at the University of Guelph's Controlled Environments Systems research facility in Ontario, Canada, involved finding methods to recycle the air which astronauts breathe inside a lunar module or space station. He and his team hit upon the idea of integrating two ideas: the use of natural microbes to deal with polluted air, and the use of plants to restore a contaminated environment.

'I guess the big moment was when we saw how we could take those two general ideas ... and just tweak them slightly, so the system would work indoors,' Dr Darlington explains. 'There were all kinds of mathematics and engineering, but it was really just "If we did this and this – wow". At the same time, once we started working on the system, we said, "Well, they're not really making many lunar bases".' So for his idea to work in business terms, he needed to find a better market for it than space was likely to offer. He therefore began to think about using the same technology to remove harmful substances from the air people breathe inside buildings right here on Earth. 'Developing the project required another three years,' says Dr Darlington. 'It took that long to take an idea that was working really well in a laboratory, and translate it into something that would be effective on an industrial scale,' he recalls.

For this phase, the funding he obtained from the Ontario Centres of Excellence (OCE) was key. This organisation provides support to help industries get research done at

academic institutions in Ontario. But it may also help recent graduates who have a business idea that originated with the university, by supporting them for up to two years while they get it off the ground.

As a result of this support, Dr Darlington was able to set up a company, Nedlaw Living Walls, in 2001. The first living wall, set up in the University of Guelph's new Humber campus facility in 2004, was followed by another in Toronto the same year. Currently, some 150 living walls are flourishing inside buildings across North America, and they have led to Nedlaw receiving a number of prestigious awards.

The projects advertise themselves better than anything else could, according to Dr Darlington. For example, since they installed their largest-ever living wall at Drexel University's Papadakis Integrated Sciences Building in Philadelphia, the company has been contacted by many local people impressed by what they have seen.

Soaring as high as five storeys in some cases, brilliant with the cascading greenery of foliage, ferns and flowering plants, the living walls provide an environment which can make being indoors seem like a walk through the rainforest – and they also save companies a lot of expense. The walls include a system which actively moves air over the plants' leaves, roots and growth medium, eliminating at least 90 per cent of the dust present in the air. So business owners don't have to worry about using ventilation systems to bring in fresh air from outside – they can simply let the living wall clean the air for them. There is some evidence that they may cut down sickness among staff who work in the environment, and businesses which have installed them have also found that they improve productivity by making employees feel more cheerful and motivated.

As well as ten employees based in their Ontario headquarters, Nedlaw employs teams of subcontractors to look after the walls in distant cities. The plants get monthly maintenance visit as part of the package.

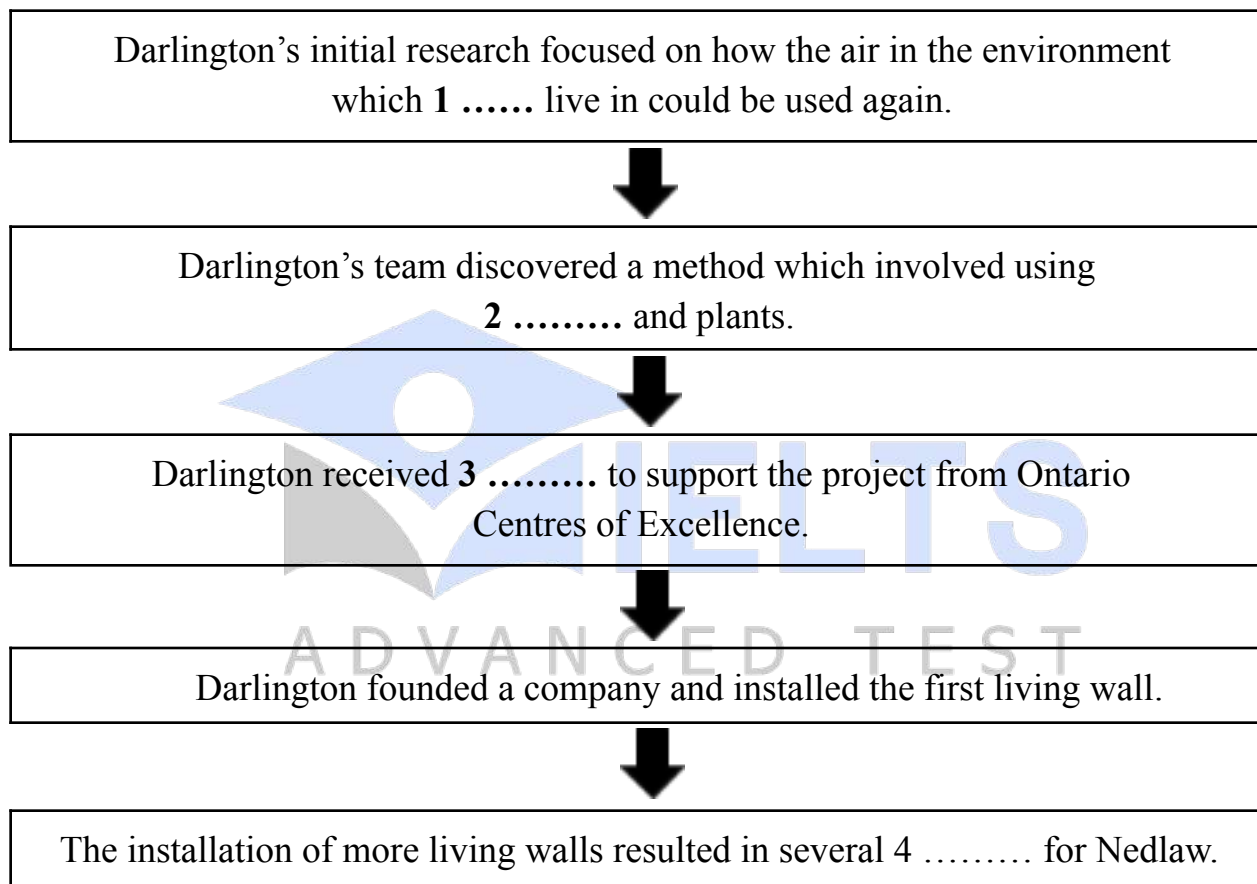
‘There is a potential for reduced capital and operating expenses,’ says Dr Darlington. ‘We have the numbers to support what we’re doing, so we can actually substantiate our claims about the improvement in air quality and productivity in a building. In fact, as building firms look for new and better ways to construct the spaces where people work and live, a living wall may well be the most obvious sign of such progressive thinking, acting as a marker of dedication to the green movement and green design.’

Questions 1-4

Complete the flow-chart below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer. Write your answers in boxes 1-4 on your answer sheet.*

Stages in the commercial development of Living Walls



Questions 5-9

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer. Write your answers in boxes 5-9 on your answer sheet.*

The advantages of living walls

Living walls:

- create a pleasant environment similar to a **5**
- remove almost all the **6** from the air
- make it unnecessary to install **7** equipment
- reduce employee **8**
- encourage positive feelings and so increase **9**

Questions 10-13

*Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?
In boxes 10-13 on your answer sheet, write*

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information*

FALSE *if the statement contradicts the information*

NOT GIVEN *if there is no information on this*

10. Dr Darlington believes that some academics may lack the ability to turn their ideas into commercially successful ventures.

11. Dr Darlington switched the focus of his project from space to Earth because of technical problems.

12. It was difficult for Dr Darlington to persuade his team to spend another three years developing the project.

13. Once a living wall has been established, it survives without any further care.

READING PASSAGE 2

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14 - 26, which are based on Reading Passage 2 on pages 7 and 8.

American Businesses Aim to Support Employees and Their Families

A Companies of all sizes in the US recognize the importance of family-friendly policies, thanks in large part to the increasing number of people-centered entrepreneurs and company CEOs. Many of these go into business themselves as a result of negative experiences they have had in the workplace. So says Jennifer West, Managing Director of the Ohio-based Business Research Center, a non-profit organization dedicated to studying work-life balance. 'Taking a people centered view is a good recruitment and retention strategy,' says West. 'Employers who care about their employees and help them grow take into account the full range of issues and the external pressures that employees have and arrange things so that people can manage their lives. These considerations are a conscious part of how people-centered bosses organize their practices and strategies.'

B One employer who exemplifies this philosophy is Stephen Harper, co-owner and CEO of Plastic Solutions in California. His company manufactures custom plastics, mainly for medical devices, and offers engineering solutions for other plastics needs. Harper believes in having employees who understand the business. That's why every two weeks, when his employees receive their salary, they also get an update about the company, including who their new customers are, what successes they've had, and what challenges they are facing. Harper also includes a 'coaching' section. This addresses issues like gossip, which employees sometimes indulge in around the water cooler or the rest rooms, and which can negatively impact on the morale of staff. He encourages people to work their way up in the company, and pays, at least partially, for educational opportunities and textbooks. His employees line up to attend his monthly invitation-only Business Pragmatics seminar, in which communication and other vital skills are taught, along with ethics and workplace morals and philosophy. The structure of his company is very family-friendly, and includes a regular Open House day for employees' families where, among other things, kids can experiment with the company's machines that manufacture their products and so on. The Harper philosophy pays off. Attrition at the company is low, and many employees remain with the company for much of their career.

C In Vermont, the Margaret Mills Corporation also strives to be people-centered. It is a third generation, family-run business that sells children's wooden toys internationally, and the company's founder (Margaret Mills) understood all too well the challenges of raising a family while running a business. Like many other like-minded companies, the Margaret Mills Corporation offers liberal leave, flexi-time, good health and retirement packages, and other benefits. The corporation also allows workers to have their children dropped off when school is over, or to spend time with them during the vacations. Annual Christmas and summer parties are standard, and this year, to celebrate an especially strong performance, the company took all employees and their families on a 2-day trip to Montreal, Canada. Says Victor Davies, Human Resources Director, 'We enable employees to maintain equilibrium between work and home, a policy which ultimately results in a more productive and stable workforce.' It works – this year the company will celebrate six 5-year anniversaries, and one 25-year anniversary among its employees.

D For Hazel Gibbs, CEO of Disposal Systems Inc. in Houston, Texas, a waste disposal and environmental cleanup and consultancy firm, the bottom line is keeping her business going. But she realizes that it takes a certain kind of mutuality to do that. 'I'm not altruistic,' she says, 'but if everyone understands what it takes to be in business, that's good for all of us.' That's why she works hard to ensure that everyone, from managers to workers, realizes that they count. 'It's not about "us" and "them", we are a team,' Gibbs says. 'When our employees understand what it takes to keep a business going, then it works and we can accommodate each other's needs.' Despite her success, Gibbs sometimes struggles with being taken seriously. She sees this as a long-term challenge. 'Working mothers still need to be taken more seriously, and so do mothers who are business owners.' She has two children of her own to think about.

E Family-friendly entrepreneurs are becoming more commonplace internationally, and they clearly influence those companies which have so far been slow to accommodate employee needs. According to West, it is already possible to document the dwindling workforces of these latter businesses, or the migration of labor to more family-friendly ones. What is more, parents are important consumers and investors who can change buying practices. Further, in the public policy arena, multinational corporations and aid agencies are beginning to recognize the need to integrate social and economic policy and practice. Family-friendly employers are creating a groundswell of awareness that can only result in changing business practices. And as Hazel Gibbs says, when that happens, 'you've got it working.'

Questions 14–18

The text has five paragraphs, A–E.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

- 14. a description of a company that provides financial assistance for employees to continue their learning
- 15. a mention of worldwide trends in the changing attitudes of businesses and customers
- 16. details about years of continuous service by employees at one company
- 17. a reference to the reason why many people-centered workers first start their own businesses
- 18. a comment about how certain groups are still fighting for respect in the business world

Questions 19–21

Choose the correct business person, A–E, for each statement.

- 19. Employees should be kept informed about business development and performance.
- 20. Work output increases when employees have a good balance between company and family responsibilities.
- 21. It is critical to business success that all company members recognise that they matter.

List of business people

- A. Jennifer West
- B. Stephen Harper
- C. Margaret Mills
- D. Victor Davies
- E. Hazel Gibbs

Questions 22–26

Complete the summary.

*Write **ONE WORD ONLY** from the text for each answer.*

Family-friendly practices at Plastic Solutions and the Margaret Mills Corporation

At Plastic Solutions, a bi-weekly update is issued to workers at the same time as their pay. This includes a section dealing with problems such as **22** in communal areas of the workplace. The CEO also arranges a regular **23** for selected employees for whom places are in great demand. Finally, employees' families are invited to company open days, when they are allowed to try out the **24** The Margaret Mills Corporation allows employees a great deal of flexibility with their children, who can be brought to the office once **25** has finished. Mills likes to reward employees for company performance with a party or even a **26** for families. There is considerable evidence that these practices are having the desired effect.



READING PASSAGE 3

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27–40 which are based on Reading Passage 3 on pages 9 and 10.

Child's Play in Medieval England

Professor Nicholas Orme investigates childhood in the Middle Ages

A ‘Play up! Play up! And play the game!’ The ringing chorus of Sir Henry Newbolt’s celebrated cricket poem “*Vitai Lampada*” (1908) sums up views about play in 19th- and early 20th-century Britain. Children’s play was important, and adults should regulate and direct it. Games promoted endurance, self-discipline and team spirit – qualities needed for the health of society and

government. Newbolt was one in a long line of people who thought in this way. The notion that children’s play should be used for educational and social purposes goes back at least to the ancient Greeks and the toys and games of medieval England tell us much about how adults then saw childhood. But they also reveal a good deal about children themselves, and cast light on what has recently become a controversial issue.

B Forty years ago, the French historian Philippe Ariès argued, in *Centuries of Childhood*, that childhood in the Middle Ages did not exist in its modern sense. Children were regarded by adults with relatively little affection and followed a way of life not very different from that of their elders. More recent historians have disputed this, pointing to plentiful signs of parental affection and arguing that childhood, by its very nature, must always have been much the same.

C In this debate play is crucial. Did adults encourage it? If so, did they see it as recreational (by providing toys, for example) or as educational (making children play in particular ways)? Did children play as their elders told them, or did they invent their own games, away from adults and even against their wishes? These questions can be answered from a rich body of evidence including actual toys of the period, pictures of children’s activities in contemporary manuscripts and literary sources such as religious works and dictionaries. We know not only how medieval English children played but what their elders thought on the subject.

D We know, for example, that adults gave children toys from infancy onwards. In 1398 the writer John Trevisa describes babies playing with ‘*a child’s brooch*’, an object similar in function to the bright plastic toys given to babies today to bite and handle. William Horman, 16th-century author of a Latin textbook, talks of buying a rattle to stop a baby crying. Indeed, by 1300 it appears there was a toy industry in England. Boys’ toys often

took military forms, such as the two metal soldiers of that date, found in London, and made from a mould. Girls had dolls, known before the 17th century as ‘poppets’ or puppets, commercially manufactured, imported and, in 1582, taxed at a halfpenny each.

Not that children were by any means dependent on things that were bought for them. Gerald of Wales recalls how he and his brothers built towns, palaces, churches, and monasteries from sand at Manorbier Castle in about 1150 (perhaps on the nearby beach).

E Active games were universal. In his English-to-Latin dictionary of 1440, a mysterious recluse known as Geoffrey mentions children playing ‘tennis’ and swinging on what he calls a ‘totter’ or ‘merrytotter’. Children chased each other, swam and played ball games. Boys in the later Middle Ages shot arrows with bows, and archery is an example of a sport encouraged by adults, who wanted boys to grow up to play their part in what was, for most men, a warrior society.

F However, by no means all children’s military activity was directed by adults. In 1400, six months after King Richard II had been overthrown by Henry IV, the children of London gathered together and chose themselves kings. Adam of Usk tells us they congregated ‘in thousands ... and made war upon each other... whereby many died’. The new king had to order their parents and masters to stop them.

G This willingness of children to take the initiative in play, not just to wait for adults to direct them, is evident in the way they observed the calendar. Medieval life was regulated by light, weather, crops and the Church’s cycle of fasts and festivals. Children shared in the adult round of religious festivals, but had their own observances as well, semidetached from their elders. In the 1200s, the priest Thomas Dodington remarked that in spring a child ‘follows the ploughman; in autumn he accompanies the grape-gatherers’.

In 1518, the poet Alexander Barclay records children playing with tops in March, looking for fruit in summer and making footballs by filling pigs’ bladders with dried peas in autumn.

H It is clear from this evidence that the relationship between adults and children in medieval society was, in major respects, a modern one. Parents took an indulgent interest in their children, providing them with toys and giving them time to play. Children played in a wide variety of ways – imaginatively, skilfully, athletically and violently – developing their minds, bodies and social skills. Adults tried at times to direct play – partly to keep children in order, partly to give them skills for adult life – but children gravitated to one another and formed a culture of their own. We can answer Ariès’s thesis, then, with a resounding ‘No!’. Childhood has always been much the same.

Questions 27–31

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter A–H in boxes 27–31.

- 27.** economic evidence for play in medieval England
- 28.** an example of how children created their own toys
- 29.** an example of warlike play approved by grown-ups
- 30.** a political event mirrored in children's play
- 31.** the origin of an academic debate about medieval life

Questions 32–35

Look at the following dates (Questions 32–35) and the list of events below.

Match each date with the correct event, A–J.

Write the correct letter. A–J, in boxes 32–35 on your answer sheet.

- 32.** 1400
- 33.** 1518
- 34.** 1582
- 35.** 1908



List of Events

- A.** invention of cricket
- B.** children picking grapes
- C.** poem about value of games
- D.** early toy manufacturing in England
- E.** puppets first imported into England
- F.** dolls taxed in England
- G.** death of Adam of Usk
- H.** children playing tennis
- I.** children's gang warfare
- J.** a description of seasonal activities

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3? In boxes 36–40 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information*

FALSE *if the statement contradicts the information*

NOT GIVEN *if there is no information on this*

36. Little is known about adult attitudes to children's play in the Middle Ages.

37. Most toys were imported into England before 1300.

38. Medieval children celebrated the seasons in their own ways.

39. Medieval children made presents for their parents on special occasions.

40. Parents and children in the Middle Ages behaved much as they do today.

